Reagan's Path to Victory

THE SHAPING OF RONALD REAGAN'S VISION: SELECTED WRITINGS

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A Note on Editorial Methods

In producing a printed version of what Reagan wrote in his own hand, we have followed the same methods we did in *Reagan, In His Own Hand.*[1] We show his own inserts in small italic capital letters when he used caps, in italics when he added in script rather than capitals. His deletions are shown with a single strike-over except where we could not read what he struck out. Unreadable strike-overs are shown with only a single "≠" symbol.

We have not corrected spelling or punctuation, nor have we expanded the abbreviations he often used. His placement of apostrophes in contractions, however, was as casual as the dotting of an i, and so we have located apostrophes (when he used them at all) in their conventional place.

Reagan's marginal comments and instructions are indicated by the dagger (†) symbol and are printed at the end of the document on which they appear. Asterisks are used to indicate editors' footnotes, and are at the bottom of the page. In the rare cases where editorial changes were made by someone other than Reagan or where we have inserted a word he left out, we present those edits in brackets.

The titles of the documents are the titles that Harry O'Connor of O'Connor Creative Services used in distributing them, rather than the even briefer identifiers Reagan used when he wrote them. The dates given are taping dates, each of which is the closest known date to the time of writing. The taping dates of course preceded the distribution date and can be estimated in those cases where it is unknown. Radio broadcasts were usually taped in batches of 15, although at first fewer were taped at a time. Sometimes Reagan would tape as many as 20 broadcasts, the additional ones held for distribution when he was traveling abroad or on vacation. The air dates can therefore be two to five weeks, sometimes more, after the taping date.

Reagan wrote his radio commentaries in two parts. First, he used a brief introduction or "teaser" to entice the radio audience to stay tuned to the station. He finished this part by saying "I'll be right back." Then, after radio commercials, he would read his essay for the day. Each of the commentaries ended with: "This is Ronald Reagan. Thanks for listening."

Three different versions of most of the radio commentaries can be found in

the archives. One is Reagan's handwritten draft. The typed version of his draft prepared by his staff is also in the archives, sometimes including his own further editing for clarification or to shorten the length of the broadcast. The third version is the printed transcript of Reagan's taping session prepared by O'Connor Creative Services for distribution to radio stations so that they could see what was on the tapes or vinyl records being sent to them. Stations also used these transcripts to respond to listeners' requests for printed copies of the program. The O'Connor version does not include Reagan's teaser or his sign-off.

Asia
June 27, 1978

A very well qualified observer of world affairs has returned from a swing through Asia with some comments you might find interesting. I'll be right back.

An executive with what must be the worlds biggest news agency recently made a trip to Asia where because of his position he met with govt. officials, industrial leaders, publishers and others able to contribute sound views on the countries he visited. He has returned with information that ~~present~~ *does not* always jibe with the doctrinaire views we get from diplomats & some commentators who often see things only in the light of their own bias. He was protected against ≠ indoctrination by the variety of his contacts; he could check the things he gathered from one source against the views of others.

He told me that he too had found an almost universal anxiety over our foreign policy. Everyone in S. Korea was convinced that N. Korea would attack if the U.S. presence was reduced. He was astounded to learn from qualified sources in detailed breifings that N. Korea is capable of producing it's own ~~armored forces~~ *vehicles armor.* Also that most of it's artillery is concentrated in hardened positions along the demilitarized zone capable of shelling Seoul & the surrounding area in which is located almost all of S. Koreas industry.

In all of his contacts in Korea he found no hostility toward the U.S. He also found a resolve on the part of the people to counter communism at any cost. That's a little ~~contrary~~ *contrary* to the view we're so often given of S. Korean unhappiness with their own leaders. The 2 questions he was asked most often were: "What must we do to show you that we are your true friends?" And "Dosen't your Pres. know that a communist attack on S. Korea will eventually engulf all of Asia?"

His next step was Taiwan where he met with many of the same officials I had met with plus numerous others in business & the press. He came away with a feeling that Taiwan might not find a 2 China's policy impossible to live

with; that we could pursue establishing diplomatic relations with Communist China without renouncing our treaties & our recognition of the Free Repub. of China. Our Sec. of State should discover that.

He found as we did on our visit that the Chinese on Taiwan are hardworking and very proud of their economic achievements & their constant progress toward a more democratic govt. Being there on an election day he visited polling places and watched not only the voting but the counting of ballots. He suggests we might have a few precincts in some of our *own* cities where that ~~might not~~ *wouldn't* be possible.

On Taiwan he ran into one oft-repeated question; "Why must you slap your friends in the face while kowtowing to those who have never shown their friendship toward you." Do any of us have an answer to that?

The windup on Taiwan was his briefing on "intelligence operations." ~~Very~~ Mainland Chinese manage to get hundreds of reports a week over to Taiwan on conditions in Red China. Some are written by *members of the* military. ~~personnell~~ All present a picture quite different from the canned tour Americans are given when they visit Peking.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

Taiwan III
January 1979

Once more I'd like to talk about the change in our relations with the Repub. of China on Taiwan & the Communist rulers in Peking. Ill be right back.

In the first days following the Dec. 15th announcement that we were abrogating our treaty with Taiwan, spokesmen for the admin. and some pundits of the press declared we were simply recognizing a reality. After all there are something like a bil. Chinese on the mainland and only 17 mil. on Taiwan. It was foolish to pretend the govt. on Taiwan was the govt. of China. But isn't *it* just as foolish to pretend that the govt. ~~on~~ in Peking is the rightful ruler of Taiwan?

If we're going to put this on the basis of looking at reality there are a few things we shouldn't overlook. The Peking govt. once allied with Russia as part of the world communist ~~govt.~~ movement now see's Russia as not being true to the ~~ten~~ principles of Karl Marx. Soldiers of the 2 great communist powers face each other across a long border and China proclaims Russia is ~~the~~ an enemy & a threat to peace.

But China also says we are an *imperialist* enemy ~~that~~ *which* must eventually be destroyed. To their own people the Communist leaders explain that we aren't an immediate threat as is the Soviet U. so first things first. ~~If & when they turn on us they can do so with a clear conscience. They'll only~~

And if they should ever decide we're enemy number 1 not number 2, they can do so with a clear conscience. They'll only be doing to us what we've done to Taiwan.

With Congress back in session there are things we can do to lessen the damage that ~~Presidents~~ has been done. We dont have just one treaty or agreement with Taiwan. We have about 50. We do around $7 bil. worth of business with Taiwan.

The President can say all these things will continue on a non-governmental basis but that's impossible. Granted he has the power to close the embassy and re-open it in Peking but govt. representation by us in Taiwan & by the Repub. of China ~~is~~ here is essential. The same *daily* functions performed now by embassies & consulates must *STILL* be performed if we are to maintain trade & cultural relations.—So we call them liason offices but they are official govt. institutions.

Congress can make sure that most of those 50 treaties & agreements remain in force & that we *REALLY DO* provide the ~~R~~ people of Taiwan with the weapons they need to defend themselves. Your congressman needs to hear from you right now with regard to this.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖